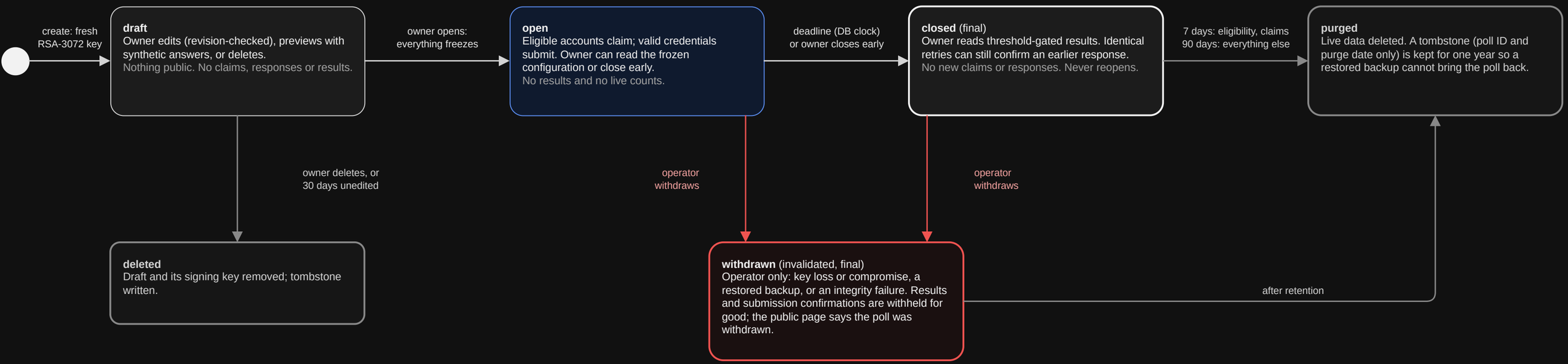
Poll lifecycle · states, freezes and locks

Closed is final: no reopening, deadline extensions or edits after opening. Deadlines use the database clock; client clocks never authorize anything. Source: SPEC.md §4, §13, §15.



Frozen at opening
Title, description, questions and option IDs/order, the eligibility list, closes_at (10 minutes to 30 days ahead), policy and thresholds, key ID and public key.

Enforced by database constraints and triggers as well as application code. The owner can never supply or replace a signing key.

Locks and ordering
- Same order everywhere: poll row → redeem advisory lock → claim or response row.
- Claim and new response: SELECT … FOR SHARE on the poll; check open, not withdrawn and clock_timestamp() < closes_at; hold the lock to commit.
- Close or withdraw: exclusive poll lock, which waits for admitted claims and inserts to finish.
- Results: take the closure lock and materialize closure before building the snapshot.
- Lock waits and transactions ≤ 2 s. Key generation, signature checks and signing happen outside the lock; signing only after the claim commits.